rendered their enemies politically irrelevant. Rather, they continually articulate fears of existential threats both to themselves personally and to the Buddhist religion, as well as to rather amorphous, loosely attached and weakly conceptualized notions of "race" (see Walton 2013; Nyi Nyi Kyaw 2015). By forcing a collectivity out of the political community that is Myanmar, if not its physical territory, they reduce their relations with that collectivity to violence and its epiphenomena.

This violence might be collective, but it is not political, first, because it wants for an essentially political quality, as already discussed, and secondly, because it emphatically rejects the possibility of political relations with the other. Schissler's interlocutors must characterize Islam as an inherently violent religion. Their project precludes any other characterization. In so doing, it denies the political fundamentally. But it also diminishes the opportunities for political action of its participants, because it robs them of alternatives.

The diminishing of the political through reactions to anti-Muslim violence is evident too in the chapter by Tamas Wells (2016). Bringing the idea of essential contestability (Gallie 1956) to democratization in Myanmar, Wells argues that people interpret this violence differently because they have competing conceptions of democracy. Contrasting what he calls liberal, moral and equality narratives on democracy and democratization, he discusses how each leads its narrators to different explanations for the violence; different conclusions about its implications and different prescriptions for what might be done about it.

Wells emphasizes, and I agree, that argumentation over political ideas need not be progressive. Nevertheless, it does need to be authentic. My concern is that what passes for argumentation in his account may not consist of the dialogue necessary to be authentic, but merely of a number of disconnected monologues. Furthermore, the kind of argumentative exchange necessary for the political is conditional on the bringing together of interlocutors who disagree with one another but who at least recognize the other as someone who is entitled to speak and act politically. Where people who ought to be involved in the argument are denied any political standing, where they are reduced to the "abstract nakedness of being nothing but human" (Arendt 1994, p. 300), these conditions cannot be met.